

HENRY MELLER

Meller Turns Lingfield Around

Bottom of the Wooden Spoon table overnight, Henry Meller answered with the best round anyone shot all day.

Henry Meller arrived at Lingfield Park Golf Club carrying the wreckage of a wretched opening round. He left with something close to dignity. It took him three holes to reach the bottom of the 2011 Wooden Spoon standings, a quadruple bogey 8 at the 3rd depositing him last of the five. From there he did something unexpected. He played golf. Pars at the 9th, 10th and 11th gained him three shots against net par without a single gross shot dropped. It was a stretch of genuine, unfussy competence, and

it ended at the 12th, one of Lingfield's hardest holes, with a triple bogey. The 15th, the hardest hole on the course, took a quadruple bogey 9 off him later. Yet the ledger was emphatic. In Round 1 he had taken 14 shots more than net par. Here he was 12 shots better, finishing just 2 over. Twelve shots of improvement is a great deal of improvement. It says as much about Round 1 as it does about Lingfield. By the close of play the cellar had a new tenant, and his name was Stuart Neumann.

AT A GLANCE

ROUND OF THE DAY
Henry MELLER (+2)

TROPHY LEAD
David MULLIN, 2 ahead

GREEN JACKET LEAD
David MULLIN, 7 ahead

ROUND NET VP
HM +2 | DM +4 | GW +7 | JB +9 | SN +9
ROUND GROSS
HM +20 | DM +22 | SN +27 | JB +33 | GW +35

AFTER R2 • TROPHY
DM +9 | JB +11 | GW +15 | HM +16 | SN +19
AFTER R2 • GREEN JACKET
DM +45 | HM +52 | SN +55 | JB +59 | GW +71

TROPHY

Mullin Overtakes At The Death

A three-shot cushion and a brief mid-round lead both disappeared for Jon Baker inside the space of six holes.

On Lingfield's back nine the lead in the 2011 Trophy changed hands three times inside four holes. Jon Baker went ahead outright with a bogey on the 12th, one of the course's harder holes. David Mullin twice drew back level, never ahead, first with a bogey on the 10th and then another on the 13th. It was polite, orderly and entirely temporary.

The decisive blow came late. Baker ran up a quintuple bogey nine on the 17th, another of Lingfield's tougher holes, and turned his round into his worst to date at +9. Mullin was chanceless in nothing, closing with a quadruple bogey nine of his own on the 18th. It cost him precisely nothing. He did not win the round by playing well. He won it by taking his nine one hole later

than Baker took his. By the close Mullin held the outright Trophy lead, two shots clear, where Baker had led by three at the round's start. The Green Jacket picture was untouched, Mullin still out front there too. His cushion in that race had stretched to seven.

WOODEN SPOON

Neumann Takes Over Last Place

Three holes without a net par at the start proved costly enough to swap him with Henry Meller at the foot of the Wooden Spoon standings.

Stuart Neumann's second round at Lingfield was over before it had properly begun. A triple bogey at the 1st. A quadruple bogey 9 at the par-5 2nd. A double bogey at the 3rd. Nine gross shots gone in three holes, and not one net par among them to slow the bleeding. The 2nd is stroke index 16, which is to say Lingfield offered him its gentlest hole as a welcome. He returned a nine. It was there that he slipped to the bottom of the Wooden Spoon race, and he reinforced the position with further double bogeys at the 5th and 9th, in the manner of a man signing a document twice for safety. Before the round Henry Meller had occupied the cellar. By the finish it was Neumann, three shots off the next-worst in the race. A difficult reintroduction to a course he was visiting for the first time in the TEG. His best gross score there, 99, came only after this rocky start had already done the damage.

LINGFIELD

A Debut Course Takes No Prisoners

Every member of the field carded at least one hole of quadruple bogey or worse on Lingfield's first outing in the TEG rota.

Round two of TEG 4 took the field to Lingfield Park Golf Club in Surrey for the first time. The parkland course formed an immediate opinion of its visitors and acted on it. All five players found trouble at some point. Gregg Williams found more than his share. A quintuple bogey 9 at the 3rd, one of the course's harder holes, then quadruple bogeys at the 9th and the 8th. Thirteen shots to par surrendered across three holes, in a single round.

Jon Baker's title challenge suffered too. He had led the TEG 4 Trophy going into the round. He ran up a 9 at the 17th, and by the close David Mullin had moved to the front with a two-shot gap. Mullin was not spared either, closing with a quadruple bogey 9 at the 18th. Henry Meller and Stuart Neumann completed the carnage with quadruple bogeys of their own. Neumann's dropped him to the back of the field for the Wooden Spoon.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 4, Round 2

PERSONAL WORSTS

— Jon Baker's worst round to date: +9